Storey — 365-day roadmap

2026-11-18 → 2027-05-21

> ***Do not open this document until `ROADMAP-180.md` shows:***
>
> 1. *≥20 paying contractors* ✅
> 2. *₹40–80k MRR* ✅
> 3. *v1.3 shipped, customer-validated* ✅
>
> *If those aren't true, close this file. The 365-day plan assumes scale economics are proven. Without that, it's fantasy.*

The 365-day theme

> ***From founder-led repeatable sales to a company that runs without your hands on every customer.***

180 days proved you could sell repeatably. 365 days is about turning that motion into a *company*: a first hire who removes the bottleneck, a seed round (optional) that buys runway, a product that doesn't need you in every demo.

This is the horizon where Storey stops being "what Karun built" and starts being "the thing Karun runs."

Three milestones — these are the gates

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DAY 240  →  35 paying contractors · ₹80-150k MRR · First hire onboarded
DAY 300  →  50 paying contractors · v2 features in beta
DAY 365  →  ₹2L+ MRR · Series-A-credible OR cashflow-positive (founder choice)
```

Customer lane

Item	Done =
Reach 50 paying contractors by Day 365	₹100k–250k MRR depending on mix of solo / multi-site
First enterprise conversation	Tier-2 builder with 10+ sites. Visible ₹50k+/month, multi-year. May not close but the *conversation* matters.
First customer outside NE-India	One pilot in Eastern UP / Bihar / Jharkhand / Odisha — adjacent SMB construction market
Retention >90% MoM	Stickiness validated. Churn investigated when it spikes.
First paid annual prepayments worth ≥₹3L	Customers pay upfront for the year. Cashflow signal.
Customer Council — 5 customers meeting quarterly on WhatsApp	Product feedback loop institutionalised

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Product lane

Item	Done =
v2 features in beta — pick **2 of 3**: (a) Team Activity Log, (b) Project Timeline / Gantt, (c) AI Weekly Digest for contractors	Two shipped to beta users by Day 300
First proper API or integration	Tally export for the CA. Storey + Tally = complementary.
Performance + cost audit on Supabase	Stay within Pro tier. Optimise heavy queries identified by usage.
One AI feature genuinely useful — likely voice input for daily logs	Hindi/Assamese speech-to-text proven on real sites
Material leakage detector — proprietary insight feature	The first defensible AI claim with real evidence: *"This site consumed 22% more cement than planned. 80% of the deviation is in masonry work."*
Mobile + Web + API — three-surface product	All three surfaces integrated, no surface-specific bugs

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Business lane

Item	Done =
Team of 3–4	Founder + customer success (Day 240) + 1 engineer (Day 300) + maybe 1 sales (Day 365 if MRR justifies)
No longer solo	Founder is the bottleneck on strategy + new feature priority, not daily ops
First hire — customer success / onboarding	Onboards new contractors, runs WhatsApp support, demos to prospects
Cashflow-positive on existing customers	MRR ≥ all operating costs including founder salary
Decision point — Day 270: raise or stay bootstrapped?	Documented decision with criteria. Both paths valid.
If raising: Seed round closed by Day 365	₹50L–₹2cr on a SAFE at ₹5–10cr cap. Use a banker only if syndicated. Avinash + Upmanyu intros are key.
If bootstrapped: 12+ months runway on existing MRR	Optionality, not desperation. Both paths credible.
Trademark registered	Filed in Phase 4, registered by now

Advisor lane

Item	Done =
Full bench of 5–6 active advisors	Slot #1 Avinash · #2 SMB-SaaS GTM · #3 NE incubator head · #5 CA-lawyer · #6 Angel · #7 Upmanyu architecture
One advisor each from CA-network, ConTech operator, and angel ecosystem	Strategic depth across the three networks that matter
Quarterly advisor dinner — in person, once you can afford the travel	Builds bench loyalty. Story-worthy.
First advisor introduces a paying customer	Advisor relationships produce business outcomes, not just calls

Marketing lane

Item	Done =
Recognised as *the* NE-India ConTech name	Storey is what people Google when they want a site app in NE India
One real construction industry event presence	CREDAI Assam meet, NE Builders' Conclave, or similar. Booth + demo.
Mid-tier press coverage	YourStory / Inc42 / Moneycontrol mention. Founder profile article.
Founder story content piece	Written, audio, or video — "The contractor who built ConTech." Distinct narrative, not a generic startup story.
Referral program live	One existing customer → one referral = one month free. Documented, automated.
Help centre content	20+ short videos / articles. Customers self-serve answers.

Year-2 strategic option — the sub-contractor wedge

Captured 2026-05-22, full reasoning in `docs/PRODUCT-STRATEGY.md`.

A second customer audience exists alongside main contractors: **the sub-contractors themselves** (electricians, plumbers, masons, painters) running their own multi-job operations. ~10× more sub-contractors than main contractors in NE India; same operational pain at smaller scale.

Storey's multi-tenant data model already serves them with zero code change — only marketing positioning changes.

Don't act on this in Year 1. Year 1 priorities (12-tester gate, v1.2, 20 paying main contractors, Pvt Ltd, first hire) come first.

Decide whether to activate this wedge at Day 270 as part of the raise-vs-bootstrap decision:

- If raising: the sub-contractor TAM is a story-strengthener for the deck
- If bootstrapping: activating this wedge could double the addressable customer count and accelerate cashflow positivity

Signal to watch: if a sub-contractor self-signs-up unprompted during Months 6–12, this option moves up in priority.

The Day-270 decision point — raise or stay bootstrapped?

By Day 270 (~Feb 2027), you'll have ~9 months of operating data. Use it to choose:

Path A — Raise a seed round

Choose if:

- MRR growing >15% MoM consistently
- An advisor or angel already wants in
- A clear use of capital exists (hire 2 engineers + 1 sales + 12 months runway)
- The valuation cap you can get is ≥₹8 cr post

Path B — Stay bootstrapped, profitable

Choose if:

- MRR growth is steady but not hot (5–10% MoM)
- You're already cashflow-positive
- The market is responding to product, not to capital
- You want to keep ≥80% of the company

Neither path is wrong. Many Indian SaaS founders default to Path A because that's the loud-narrative; the quiet-narrative of Path B (Zerodha, Zoho, Wingify) has produced bigger outcomes for founders. Decide based on YOUR situation.

What NOT to do in the next 6 months

- ❌ **Don't grow the team to 10 people in 6 months.** 3–4 is right. 5 if MRR justifies.
- ❌ **Don't pivot to a new vertical.** Adjacent geographies (Eastern UP, Bihar, Jharkhand) yes — adjacent industries no.
- ❌ **Don't take a strategic investor with veto rights at Series A terms in a Seed round.**
- ❌ **Don't sacrifice your relationship with Arun + the first 5 customers as you scale.** They got you here. Their feedback continues to matter more than the noise from the next 50.
- ❌ **Don't burn out.** A solo founder taking 2 days off per quarter is faking productivity. Take 1 full day off per week, no exceptions. 1 full week off per year. The roadmap accounts for this.

Day 365 — what success looks like

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Storey at Day 365 (May 2027):
  • 50 paying contractors
  • ₹2L+ MRR (or higher with multi-site mix)
  • Team of 3–4
  • Pvt Ltd 1 year old, cashflow-positive OR Seed-funded
  • Distinct founder narrative in NE-India tech
  • Two pilots outside NE-India
  • First enterprise conversation in pipeline
  • Five active advisors, one paying customer from each network
```

If you hit this, you have a credible Series A pitch ready for FY28. The next roadmap (Year 2) writes itself.

Re-open `ROADMAP-90.md` if any of these are true

1. MRR drops month-over-month
2. > *5% monthly churn for 2 consecutive months*
3. v1.3 didn't ship by Day 150
4. The first hire isn't onboarded by Day 240

When the strategic horizon breaks, return to the operational one. Hit the immediate milestones first. Then re-graduate.

What this roadmap does NOT cover

- **Year 2 (2027-2028) — Series A + national expansion.** Different document, different operating model. Write it at Day 330, not before.
- **Exit strategy.** Premature. You're building a company, not selling one.
- **Acqui-hire scenarios.** Also premature. Storey at ₹2L MRR is not an acquisition target — it's a company in motion.

Stay in the horizon. Build the next quarter. The rest follows.